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A STORY OF KARNATAKA

The Buried Temple

of the Malenad Forest



The Buried Temple

of the Malenad Forest

A tale of Vikramaditya, the forest guard,
and the King Cobras of the rain.

From Hulmane — The Saga
Retold for young readers



Vikramaditya is a forest guard. He is strong and brave. He keeps the green Malenad safe.



In the Malenad forest, the people live by the rain. The rain fills the rivers and feeds the fields.



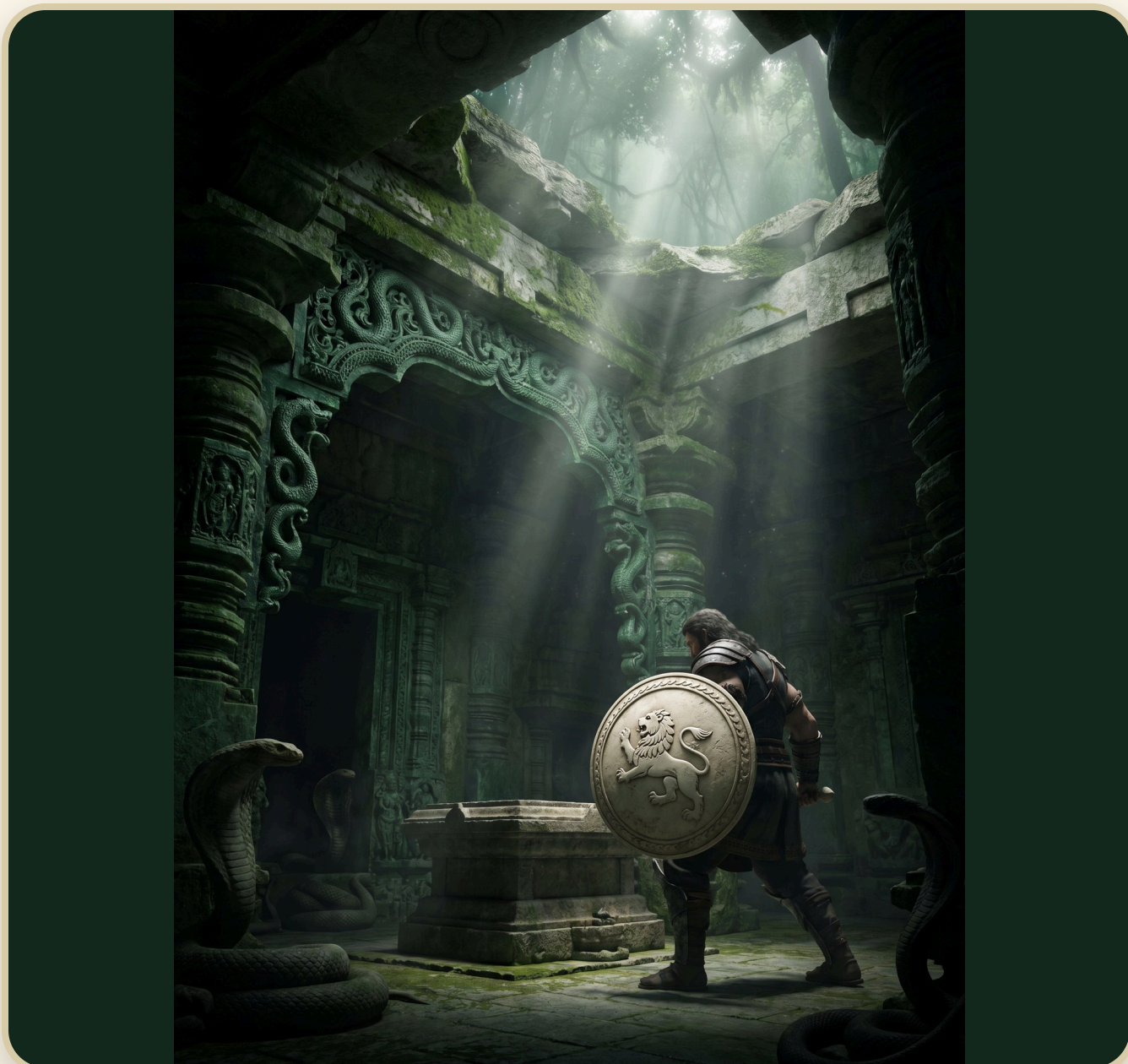
But one day the great King Cobras began to leave. “They are the soul of the rain,” said Vikramaditya.



He took up his mighty sword. “We must find them,” he said.



Karthik knew the forest well. He could read the snake tracks in the mud.



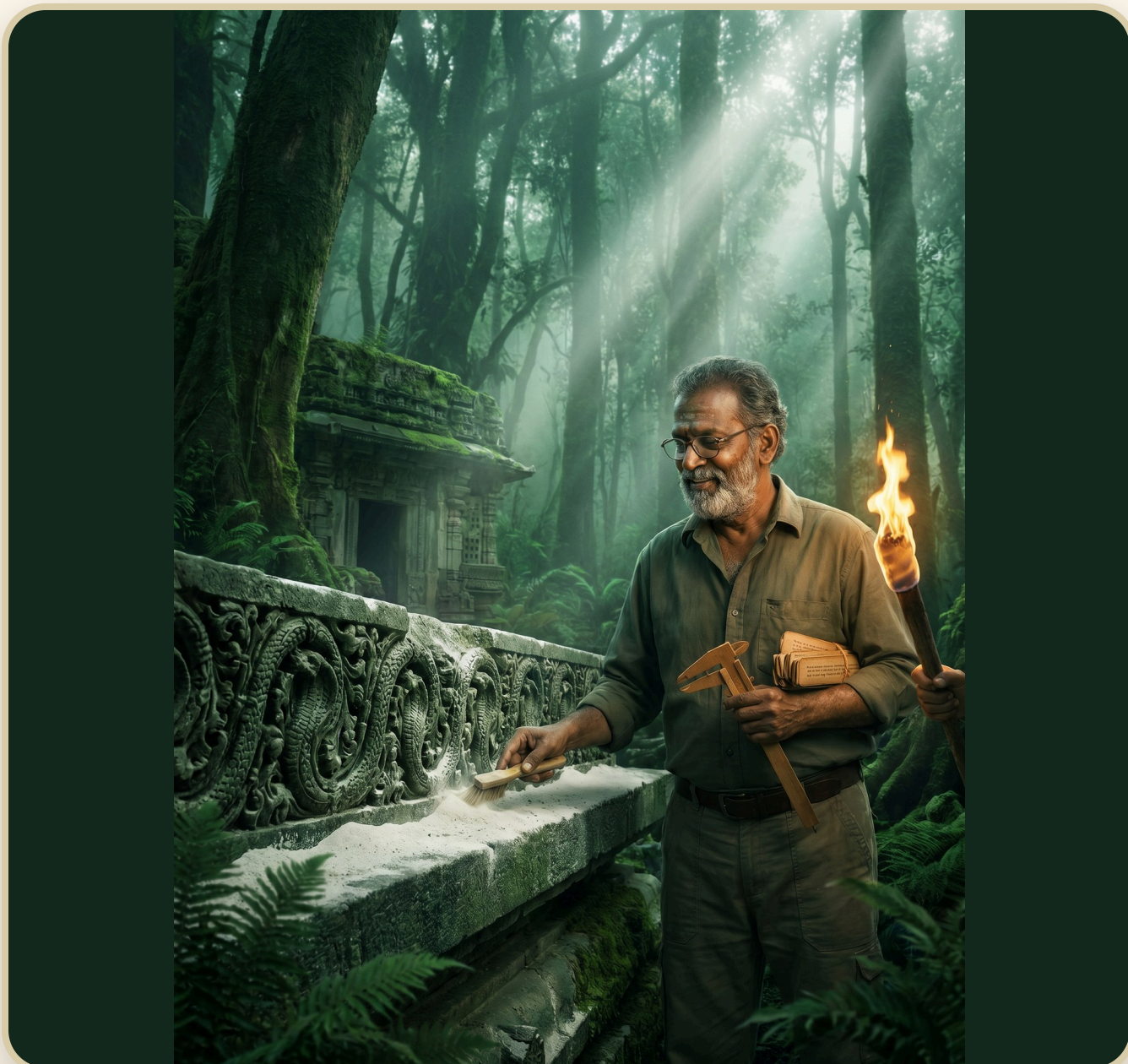
Brave Bhairava came too. He carried a strong
lion shield.



They set out at dawn. All the snake tracks led
the same way, deep into the mist.



They found a hill of white sand. Under it hid
an old, old temple.



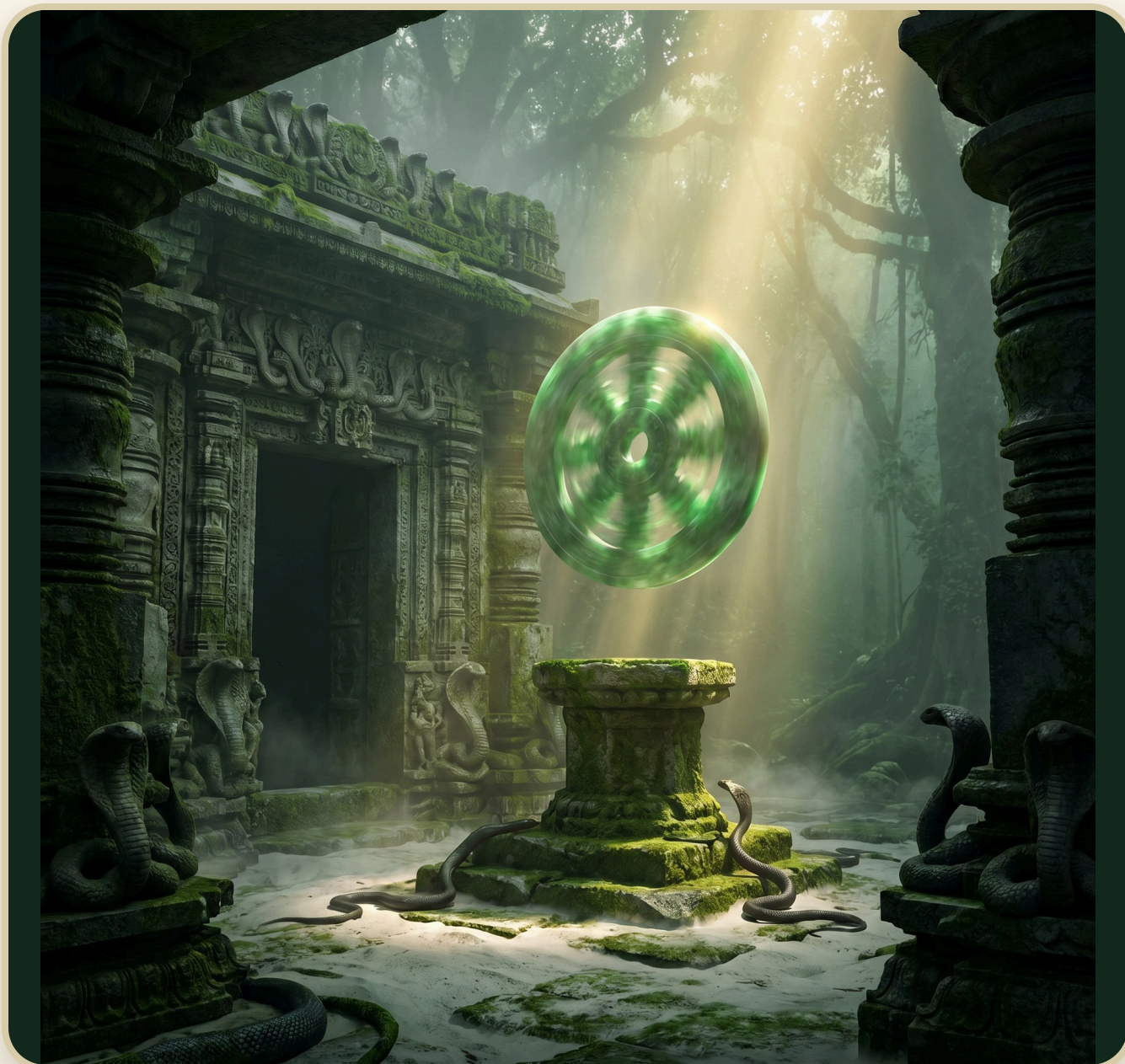
“This is a lost temple!” said Somnath. It had slept for a thousand years.



Vikramaditya lifted his torch. Slowly, he stepped inside.



Inside was a great stone hall. King Cobras
coiled in the shadows.



In the middle spun a green jade wheel. The temple was a magic machine. It called the rain.



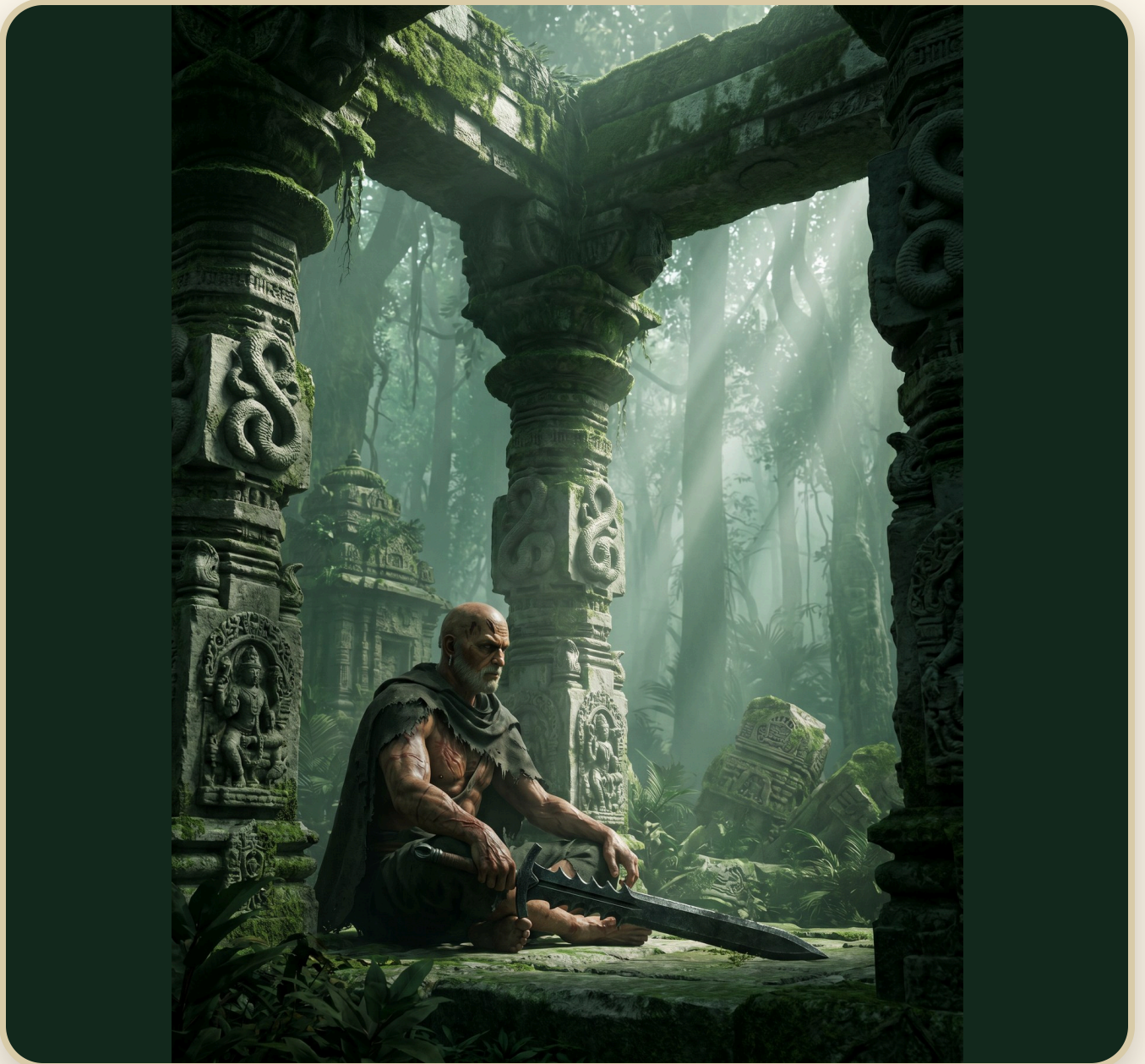
The biggest King Cobra rose up tall.
Vikramaditya bowed his head. The cobra let
him pass.



Soon armed strangers came. They wanted to steal the green jade.



“We will not take it,” said Vikramaditya. “We become the sand.” They sealed the temple away.



Now Vikramaditya guards the secret alone.
The King Cobras came home, and the rains
still fall on the green Malenad.